

► 1775–83

AMERICAN REVOLUTION

In the mid-1770s American colonists revolted against British rule and “taxation without representation”. They issued a Declaration of Independence. War broke out in 1775, ending in 1783 with the colonists winning independence and creating the United States of America.



THE US CONSTITUTION, DRAWN UP IN 1787

► 1789



THE STORMING OF THE BASTILLE, A PRISON IN PARIS, 14 JULY 1789

FRENCH REVOLUTION

This rebellion was against poverty, the nobility, and the royal family. In Paris revolutionaries demanding political change stormed the Bastille. A National Assembly was formed and the Declaration of the Rights of Man called for liberty, equality, and fraternity (brotherhood). King Louis XV and his wife, Marie Antoinette, were executed and France became a republic.

► 1791–1804

HAITIAN REVOLUTION

In the French colony of Saint-Domingue, former slave Toussaint L'Ouverture led slaves in a rebellion against slavery, burning plantations and killing their owners. Slavery was abolished on the island, which became independent Haiti.



L'OUVERTURE LEADING REVOLT AGAINST FRENCH PLANTATION OWNERS

► 1806–24

LATIN-AMERICAN REVOLUTIONS

Influenced by the American, French, and Haitian revolutions, Latin-American revolutionaries led by men such as Venezuelan Simón Bolívar and Argentinian José de San Martín rose up against Spanish colonial rule. By 1825 most of Latin America had gained independence.



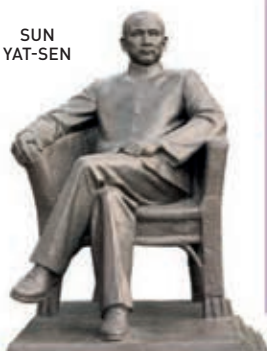
SIMÓN BOLÍVAR, KNOWN AS “THE LIBERATOR”

◀ 1911

XINHA REVOLUTION

During the Xinhai Revolution, nationalists overthrew the Manchu dynasty in China, ending 2000 years of imperial rule. They set up a republic under Sun Yat-sen, although real power stayed in the hands of provincial warlords.

SUN YAT-SEN



◀ 1910–20

MEXICAN REVOLUTION

The Mexican Revolution started as a protest against the dictatorship of President Porfirio Díaz, but soon spiralled into an armed revolution that lasted around ten years. Led by Emiliano Zapata, Pascual Orozco, and Pancho Villa, the rebels fought to reform society.

“IT IS BETTER TO DIE ON YOUR FEET THAN TO LIVE ON YOUR KNEES”

EMILIANO ZAPATA, REVOLUTIONARY LEADER

◀ 1866–68



EMPEROR MEIJI RULED 1867–1912

MEIJI RESTORATION

Led mainly by young samurai, this revolution in Japan overthrew the Tokugawa shogunate (hereditary military rulers) and restored imperial rule under Emperor Meiji. The revolution led to reforms that modernized Japan.

◀ 1848

EUROPEAN REVOLUTIONS

Often called “the year of revolutions”, in 1848 more than 50 uprisings broke out across Europe. Although these revolutions happened independently, people across the continent were banding together to demand political and social change and an end to monarchies. Thousands were killed as the uprisings were put down.



THE HUNGARIAN TRICOLOUR FLAG, A SYMBOL OF THE 1848 REVOLUTION

► 1979

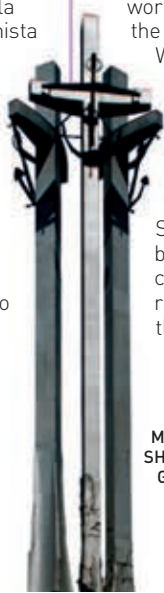
NICARAGUA

In the 1970s there were extremes of rich and poor in Nicaragua. Supported by peasants, urban workers, and the middle-classes, the guerrilla troops of the Sandinista National Liberation Front (FSLN), threw out wealthy dictator Anastasio Somoza. They introduced new socialist reforms. Later, rebel groups called the Contras fought back against the Sandinistas, who lost power in 1990.

► 1980–81

SOLIDARITY IN POLAND

Revolution broke out in Poland when the independent trade union Solidarity organized workers' strikes, under the leadership of Lech Wałęsa. They wanted liberation from Soviet control, and their actions forced the Polish government to introduce reforms. Solidarity was banned but continued their resistance until they took power.



MONUMENT TO THE SHIPYARD WORKERS, GDANSK, POLAND

► 1986



YELLOW RIBBON

YELLOW REVOLUTION

The Yellow Revolution was a series of mass popular protests in the Philippines against the corrupt regime of President Marcos. In this non-violent revolution, more than two million Filipinos demonstrated for greater democracy, displaying yellow ribbons as a symbol of protest. Marcos departed and was replaced by Corason Aquino.

► 1988–91

EASTERN EUROPE

By the late 1980s protests were spreading through the Soviet satellite states of Eastern Europe, as protesters demanded greater democracy. In Berlin demonstrators pulled down the hated Berlin Wall that divided East and West Germany, and by 1989 Communism had collapsed throughout Eastern and Central Europe.



FRAGMENT OF THE BERLIN WALL

► 2004–05

ORANGE REVOLUTION

Taking its name from orange banners and clothes of demonstrators, the Orange Revolution in Ukraine was made up of mass protests against the undemocratic election of a Russian-backed president. As a result the election was repeated and anticorruption candidate Yushchenko was elected.

► 2010–12

ARAB SPRING

Starting in 2010, a wave of pro-democracy uprisings took place in the Middle East and North Africa – Tunisia, Egypt, Libya, the Yemen, and Syria – that challenged some of the region's authoritarian governments. Protesters were met with violence, but regimes in Tunisia and Egypt were toppled.

EACH DAY 5,000 TONNES OF PORRIDGE AND 10,000 LOAVES WERE SUPPLIED TO ORANGE REVOLUTION PROTESTERS IN UKRAINE